

Why faith persists in a scientific age

Religiosity is a measure of faith or **inclination** towards religion. It **encompasses** belief, involvement, and the depth of one's **spiritual orientation**, whether at the individual or societal level. When I was conducting research for my undergraduate **thesis** on religiosity, I aimed to find both **theist** and **atheist** individuals in equal proportions. What I discovered during this search was quite **astonishing**. Before beginning, I carried the assumption that it would be easier to find atheists than theists, especially **given** the advancement of knowledge and technology in our generation. I believed that **our times**, **driven** by rationality and scientific thinking, **were** leading us away from blind belief and untested ideas, and more towards **exploration** and critical inquiry.

One of the great advantages of our **era** **is** the **abundance** of accessible information. Knowledge today is available in great quality and quantity and can be **attained** quickly with relatively less effort. Despite this, I found that living an atheist life has become rarer, even among the **contemporary** generation. It is important to clarify that in my research, I did not **assess** religiosity based solely on people's self-reported opinions. I used a psychological scale that measured belief systems, spiritual sensitivity, and religious participation. Based on these **dimensions**, each person's level of religiosity was **statistically evaluated**. This **leads to** a fundamental question. Why are people becoming more religious even as science progresses? The answer **lies** in human emotion. We are shaped by emotions. We feel because of them. We react due to them. We even **isolate** ourselves under their influence. Almost every action we take involves emotion in one way or another.

In Buddhism, more than fifty types of emotions are recognised as core elements of human experience. According to the Abhidhamma, which is a key text in the teachings of the Buddha that focuses on the psychological classification of human suffering and **liberation**, every single moment of **consciousness** includes emotion, perception, and feeling. When we say that consciousness includes emotion, we are not referring to just one feeling. Instead, it is **often** a cluster of emotions. However, at any moment, one or more emotions **tend to** dominate. This is because feelings and perception work together with emotions, **amplifying** some while **muting** others. This interaction leads to **instinctive** reactions, especially in moments that **trigger** our survival responses. The **dominance** of a particular emotion **plays** a key role in shaping our reaction in such moments.

Among all emotions, fear and shame play a central role in developing religious or spiritual tendencies. It is extremely difficult for the mind and body to **overcome** feelings of fear and shame through thought alone. This is where belief systems come in. They offer calm, security, and a sense of safety. In an unpredictable world where we know little about the future, about death, or the possibility of an afterlife, we move forward into the unknown. This lack of **certainty** creates a strong emotional need for belief in something beyond ourselves. **Belief** in the **divine** or the supernatural **fills** that **void**. According to Buddhist psychology, when faith arises in the mind, it becomes the **dominant** force among mental states. Emotions, perceptions, feelings, and even actions then begin to take shape in

alignment with that faith. On a physiological level too, faith produces a calming and peaceful sensation in the body.

This is why belief in something greater than ourselves will never completely disappear. Even if humanity someday starts living on Mars or becomes the most advanced civilisation in the universe, belief will remain. Therefore, it would be more meaningful if spiritual leaders and religious teachers focused on shaping belief systems that encourage the principles of karma and **ethical** action, rather than promoting rituals, **hypocrisy**, or **rigid** interpretations of ancient texts.

Today, many religious tendencies are **stuck in** a habit of constantly **glorifying** the past instead of shaping a **mindful** present. The truth remains that people will never stop believing. They will continue to place their faith in something, whether it is a spiritual tradition, a philosophical school of thought, or some evolving form of higher consciousness. As our understanding of the universe grows and science **advances** further, our definition of the supernatural will evolve as well. [\[Practice Exercise\]](#)

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

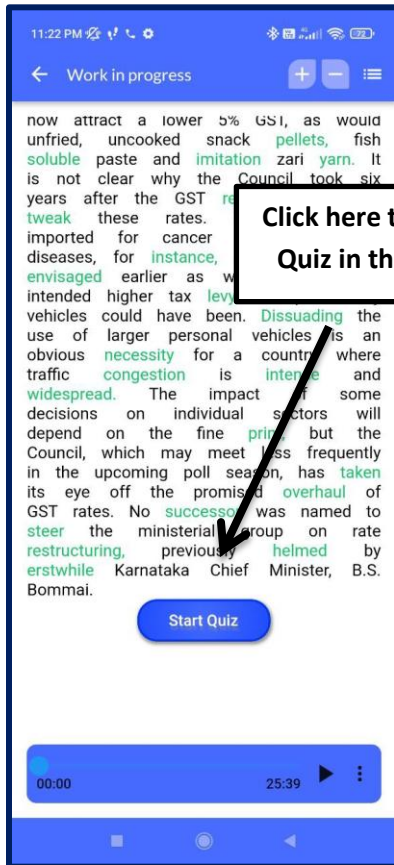
1. **Persist** (verb) – continue, endure, prevail, persevere, remain टिके रहना
2. **Religiosity** (noun) – faithfulness, devoutness, piety, spirituality, religiousness धार्मिकता
3. **Inclination** (noun) – tendency, leaning, disposition, preference, propensity प्रवृत्ति
4. **Encompass** (verb) – include, cover, comprise, incorporate, embrace सम्मिलित करना
5. **Spiritual orientation** (noun) – religious leaning, spiritual direction, inner faith, sacred focus, divine inclination आध्यात्मिक झुकाव
6. **Thesis** (noun) – dissertation, paper, research, argument, proposition शोध प्रबंध
7. **Theist** (noun) – believer, worshipper, devotee, adherent, religionist आस्तिक
8. **Atheist** (noun) – non-believer, skeptic, agnostic, unbeliever, disbeliever नास्तिक
9. **Astonishing** (adjective) – surprising, amazing, incredible, shocking, astounding आश्चर्यजनक
10. **Given** (preposition) – considering, owing to, in view of, taking into account, because of देखते हुए
11. **Drive** (verb) – motivate, propel, push, compel, influence प्रेरित करना
12. **Exploration** (noun) – investigation, inquiry, search, probing, examination अन्वेषण
13. **Era** (noun) – age, period, epoch, time, generation युग
14. **Abundance** (noun) – plenty, profusion, wealth, surplus, overflow प्रचुरता
15. **Attain** (verb) – achieve, acquire, gain, obtain, reach प्राप्त करना
16. **Contemporary** (adjective) – modern, current, present-day, up-to-date, existing समकालीन
17. **Assess** (verb) – evaluate, judge, analyze, appraise, estimate आंकलन करना
18. **Dimension** (noun) – aspect, element, facet, component, feature आयाम
19. **Statistically** (adverb) – numerically, mathematically, data-wise, quantitatively, by numbers सांख्यिकीय रूप से
20. **Evaluate** (verb) – assess, judge, examine, appraise, analyze मूल्यांकन करना
21. **Lead** (to) (verb) – cause, result in, bring about, give rise to, prompt वजह बनना
22. **Lie** (verb) – rest, reside, exist, be situated, be found निहित होना

23. **Isolate** (verb) – separate, detach, seclude, insulate, segregate अलग करना
24. **Liberation** (noun) – freedom, emancipation, release, salvation, deliverance मुक्ति
25. **Consciousness** (noun) – awareness, alertness, mindfulness, perception, sensibility चेतना
26. **Often** (adverb) – frequently, regularly, repeatedly, commonly, many times अक्सर
27. **Tend** (to) (verb) – be inclined, be likely, usually, lean towards, prone to प्रवृत्त होना
28. **Amplify** (verb) – intensify, increase, enhance, magnify, boost बढ़ाना
29. **Mute** (verb) – suppress, silence, tone down, subdue, soften दबाना / शांत करना
30. **Instinctive** (adjective) – natural, automatic, spontaneous, intuitive, impulsive सहज
31. **Trigger** (verb) – initiate, activate, prompt, set off, provoke उत्पन्न करना
32. **Dominance** (noun) – supremacy, control, authority, power, influence प्रभुत्व
33. **Overcome** (verb) – conquer, defeat, surmount, prevail over, get past काबू पाना
34. **Certainty** (noun) – sureness, assurance, confidence, conviction, predictability निश्चितता
35. **Divine** (noun) – deity, god, supreme being, higher power, celestial ईश्वर / दिव्य सत्ता
36. **Void** (adjective) – empty, vacant, lacking, absent, hollow खालीपन
37. **Alignment** (noun) – harmony, coordination, arrangement, correspondence, conformity संरेखण / मेल
38. **Ethical** (adjective) – moral, principled, righteous, virtuous, just नैतिक
39. **Hypocrisy** (noun) – insincerity, duplicity, pretense, deceit, falsehood पाखंड
40. **Rigid** (adjective) – inflexible, strict, unyielding, firm, unbending कठोर
41. **Stuck** (in) (adjective) – trapped, fixed, caught, confined, frozen फंसा हुआ
42. **Glorify** (verb) – praise, exalt, celebrate, honor, admire महिमामंडित करना
43. **Mindful** (adjective) – aware, conscious, attentive, thoughtful, alert सजग / सचेत
44. **Advance** (verb) – progress, develop, evolve, move forward, proceed प्रगति करना

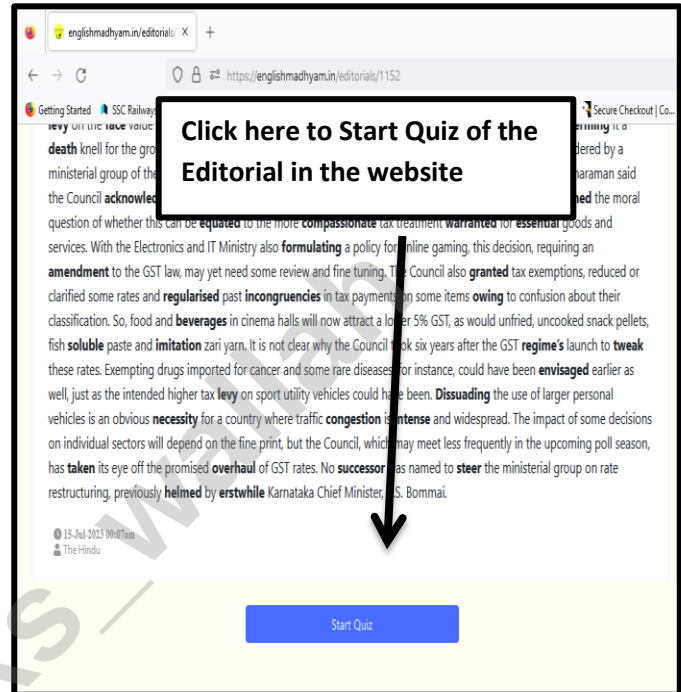
Summary of the Editorial

1. Religiosity refers to the degree of belief, involvement, and spiritual orientation towards religion in individuals or societies.
2. The author began a research project expecting atheism to be more common among the scientifically informed modern generation.
3. Contrary to expectations, the study found that atheism is rare, and religiosity remains strong even among younger people.
4. The research used psychological scales—not self-reporting—to measure belief systems, spiritual sensitivity, and religious participation.
5. The persistence of faith despite scientific progress raises a key question: Why do people remain religious?
6. The answer lies in human emotions, which drive much of our behavior and decisions, often unconsciously.
7. Buddhist philosophy, particularly the Abhidhamma, highlights that every moment of consciousness includes emotions, perception, and feelings.
8. Emotional clusters dominate our consciousness, with certain emotions like fear and shame playing a significant role in fostering spiritual tendencies.
9. These emotions are difficult to manage through logic alone, leading people to seek comfort in belief systems.
10. Belief in a higher power offers emotional stability, security, and psychological reassurance in a world full of uncertainties.
11. Faith, when it arises, becomes the dominant mental state, influencing actions, emotions, and perceptions.
12. On a physiological level, faith creates calm and peace, which helps explain its enduring appeal.
13. Even with futuristic advancements—like colonizing Mars—faith will remain a part of human existence.
14. The author argues that spiritual leaders should promote ethical action and karma, rather than rituals or rigid dogmas.
15. As science progresses, our definitions of the supernatural will evolve, but the human need to believe will persist in some form.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



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